## OBJECTIVES OF FOREIGN POLICY

Professor Jayantanuja Bandyopadhyaya (*The Making of India's Foreign Policy*, 1970) perceives the making of foreign policy as a continuous exercise in the choice of ends and means on the part of the nation-state in an international setting. A broad end or goal is necessary to give a sense of direction to foreign policy.

Broadly speaking, by foreign policy objectives, one means those things that statesmen pursue in the course of their interactions with other states. Objectives evolve, and there is hardly any consensus on how those objectives are best pursued or what the foreign policy objectives should be. This brings us to a discussion on the relation between objectives and strategy or between ends and means. Few things thought of as objectives appear to be ends in themselves, but are rather means for the achievement of still more abstract or distant ends (happiness, security, success, prestige, etc.) and objectives, which originated as a means of attaining something sometimes become an end in itself. The commonly cited example is that of the United States, objective of winning the war in Korea and Vietnam. The real motive was to contain communism which in turn was ultimately linked to the US interest to maintain stability in the international system to protect American security. Again, the objective of winning the Vietnam War was containing communism but gradually it became an end in itself because the reputation of the policy-makers depends upon the victory in the war although it became evident that the outcome of the Vietnam War was surely going to weaken the US and place the communists in a favourable position.[7]

Therefore, according to Legg and Morrison[8], a rational policy-making process to a large extent is the process of organizing clear and reliable, (i.e., the means actually lead to the desired end) means–ends chain, controlling the tendency of means to become ends in themselves and seeing that the original and more fundamental objectives are kept in perspective.

Holsti[9] identifies objectives of the states, which he arranges according to the priorities depending upon a variety of external